

Synthesize Across Sources

Workbook 2 - Apply - Focused practice

Directions

Treat each item as close-choice practice. Preserve scope, certainty, and the exact job of each piece of evidence.

Exercise 1

Source 1: Flooding occurs most often near the western trail entrance.

Source 2: Raising the full trail would cost \$2.4 million; improving drainage at the western entrance would cost \$340,000. Source 3: Engineers say drainage work would reduce minor floods but not protect against rare major storms.

Task: Which conclusion best synthesizes all three?

- A. Targeted drainage is a lower-cost way to reduce frequent minor flooding at the main trouble spot, but it is not a complete solution for major storms.
- B. Drainage will eliminate every flood.
- C. The full trail must be raised immediately because cost does not matter.
- D. The western entrance is never flooded.

Exercise 2

Source 1: A device-lending program had high demand during exam weeks.

Source 2: Repair logs show the oldest devices have twice the failure rate of newer ones. Source 3: The budget can replace only one-third of the fleet this year.

Task: Which plan is best supported?

- A. Prioritize replacing the highest-failure devices while maintaining lending capacity during peak weeks.
- B. Replace every device immediately regardless of condition.
- C. Stop lending devices during exams.
- D. Use the budget only for advertising.

Exercise 3

Source 1: Residents report noise mainly after 10 p.m. Source 2: Delivery companies save the most travel time between 8 and 11 p.m. Source 3: Quiet-equipment trials cut unloading noise substantially but do not remove it completely.

Task: Which policy is most strongly supported?

- A. Allow limited evening deliveries with quiet-equipment requirements and evaluate noise near residences before extending later.
- B. Require all deliveries after midnight.
- C. Ban deliveries at every hour.
- D. Assume quiet equipment removes all concerns.

Exercise 4

Source 1: A school roof can hold solar panels on only the south wing. Source 2: The south wing uses 38 percent of campus electricity. Source 3: The proposed system would supply about 24 percent of south-wing demand.

Task: Which statement synthesizes the evidence without overstating it?

- A. Solar panels on the south wing could offset part of that wing's electricity use but would not power the whole campus.
- B. Solar panels would eliminate the school's electricity bill.
- C. The north wing should receive the panels.
- D. The south wing uses all campus electricity.

Answer reasoning

Check your reasoning, not only your answer.

For every question, compare your reasoning with the explanation. If you missed the item, identify the exact step where your reasoning changed the source or used evidence for the wrong job.

Exercise 1

Best answer: A. Targeted drainage is a lower-cost way to reduce frequent minor flooding at the main trouble spot, but it is not a complete solution for major storms.

Why: It combines location, cost, and effectiveness while preserving the limitation.

Exercise 2

Best answer: A. Prioritize replacing the highest-failure devices while maintaining lending capacity during peak weeks.

Why: The conclusion integrates demand, reliability, and budget limits.

Exercise 3

Best answer: A. Allow limited evening deliveries with quiet-equipment requirements and evaluate noise near residences before extending later.

Why: It balances the travel-time benefit with the timing of complaints and the partial effectiveness of quieter equipment.

Exercise 4

Best answer: A. Solar panels on the south wing could offset part of that wing's electricity use but would not power the whole campus.

Why: It combines structural feasibility, energy share, and expected output at the correct scope.

Mistake check

For every miss, label the reason: wrong claim, evidence mismatch, too broad or too certain, reasoning gap, source or format confusion, or rushed reading. Then write one sentence explaining what you will check next time.